

TOPIC 7: PEACE EDUCATION

1. Meaning of Peace

Peace is a state of harmony, calmness and freedom from conflict, violence and war. It is not only the absence of war (negative peace) but also the presence of justice, fairness, respect and cooperation (positive peace).

Peace education is the process of teaching knowledge, skills, attitudes and values that help people prevent conflict, resolve disputes peacefully and live in harmony with others.

2. Importance of Peace

- It allows people to live without fear and to develop their full potential.
- It promotes economic growth, education and development.
- It protects human lives and property.
- It strengthens national unity and social cohesion.
- It creates a conducive environment for investment and progress.
- It enables the government to focus on providing social amenities instead of fighting insecurity.

3. Values that Promote Peace

The following values help to build and sustain peace:

- **Honesty** – being truthful and transparent in dealings reduces suspicion and conflict.
- **Fairness / Justice** – treating people equally and giving everyone their due.
- **Respect** – honouring the dignity, rights and opinions of others.
- **Tolerance** – accepting differences in culture, religion and opinion.
- **Empathy** – understanding how others feel and putting oneself in their place.
- **Forgiveness** – letting go of grudges and the desire for revenge.
- **Cooperation and Teamwork** – working together for common goals.
- **Love and Compassion** – showing care and kindness to others.

4. Peaceful Coexistence in the Community

Peaceful coexistence means living together in harmony despite differences in ethnicity, religion, language or social status. It requires mutual respect, understanding and the willingness to resolve disagreements without violence.

Ways to achieve peaceful coexistence:

- Respect the rights and culture of others.
- Avoid hate speech, stereotypes and discrimination.
- Participate in community dialogue and inter-faith activities.
- Report potential sources of conflict early to leaders.
- Support community development projects that benefit everyone.

5. Activities that Promote Peace in Schools and Society

In Schools:

- Peace clubs and peer mediation programmes.
- Debates, drama and essays on peace themes.

- Cultural days that celebrate diversity.
- Teaching conflict resolution skills in class.
- Anti-bullying campaigns.

In Society:

- Inter-religious and inter-ethnic dialogues.
- Community peace committees.
- Youth empowerment and employment programmes.
- Media campaigns promoting national unity.
- Traditional and religious leaders preaching peace.

6. Summary

Peace is essential for individual happiness and national development. Values such as honesty, fairness, respect and tolerance promote peace. Through deliberate education and activities in schools and communities, we can build a culture of peace and peaceful coexistence.

End of Topic 7 – Peace Education